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CONFLICT OF INTEREST POLICY

International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc.

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Approved by	Board of Directors of International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc., Resolution No. 2026-01 dated November 11, 2026

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Conflict of Interest Policy (the "Policy") is to protect the interests, integrity and reputation of International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc. (the "Association" or "IBPA") whenever the Association considers a transaction, arrangement, decision, application review, appointment, award, sponsorship, committee action or other matter that might benefit the private interest of a director, officer, committee member, reviewer, judge, employee, contractor, volunteer, member of the Association or any other person acting on behalf of the Association.

This Policy is intended to:

- promote honest, fair and objective decision-making;
- prevent improper personal benefit from the Association's activities or authority;
- protect the Association from actual, potential or perceived conflicts of interest;
- ensure compliance with applicable law and principles of good governance;
- preserve trust in the Association's leadership, application review procedures, events, awards and professional standards.

2. Persons Covered by this Policy

This Policy applies to all persons who hold a position of trust, authority, influence or decision-making in the Association, including, without limitation:

- directors;
- officers;
- committee members;
- members of the Membership Review Board;
- members of the Standards & Ethics Committee;
- judges, jury members, reviewers and evaluators;
- event organizers acting on behalf of the Association;
- employees;
- contractors;
- consultants;

- volunteers;
- any other persons designated by the Board of Directors as subject to this Policy.

For the purposes of this Policy, each such person is referred to as a "Covered Person."

3. Definition of a Conflict of Interest

A conflict of interest arises when a personal, financial, professional, family, business or other private interest of a Covered Person could interfere with, influence, undermine or appear to undermine his or her objectivity, independence, judgment or duty to act in the best interests of the Association.

A conflict of interest may be:

- actual — where the conflict already exists;
- potential — where a conflict could reasonably arise;
- perceived — where a reasonable outside observer could conclude that the person's judgment may be affected, even if no actual impropriety exists.

The existence of a conflict does not necessarily mean a violation. However, failure to disclose or properly manage a conflict may be considered a violation.

4. Examples of Conflicts of Interest

Conflicts of interest may include, without limitation, the following situations:

4.1 Financial Interest

A Covered Person has a direct or indirect financial interest in a transaction, contract, sponsorship, vendor selection, compensation matter or business relationship involving the Association.

4.2 Family or Close Personal Relationships

A Covered Person participates in a decision affecting a spouse, partner, family member, household member, close friend or other person with whom he or she has a close relationship.

4.3 Business Relationships

A Covered Person has a business partnership, employment relationship, consulting arrangement, ownership interest, referral arrangement or other economic connection with a person or organization affected by a decision.

4.4 Conflict in Membership Review

A reviewer, committee member or decision-maker evaluates an applicant, nominee, competitor, speaker, award candidate or member with whom he or she has a personal, competitive, financial, teaching, mentoring, judging or business relationship.

4.5 Conflict in Awards, Competitions and Judging

A judge or evaluator reviews a participant who is his or her student, client, employee, employer, business partner, family member, close acquaintance or direct competitor in circumstances that could affect objectivity.

4.6 Conflict in Appointments

A director, officer or committee member participates in appointing himself or herself or a closely related person to a position, opportunity, award, contract or position of public recognition without proper disclosure and independent review.

4.7 Use of the Association's Opportunities

A Covered Person uses the Association's information, authority, access, position, contacts or opportunities for personal benefit in a manner contrary to the Association's interests.

4.8 Conflict in Compensation Matters

A Covered Person participates in a decision regarding his or her own compensation, expense reimbursement, contract or other financial benefit.

4.9 Conflict in Sponsorship or Partnership

A Covered Person influences decisions on sponsorship, partnership, vendor, speaker, publication or media selection involving his or her own company, brand, employer, client or affiliate.

5. Duty to Disclose

Each Covered Person must promptly disclose any actual, potential or perceived conflict of interest as soon as it becomes known or should have become known.

Disclosure must be:

- timely;
- complete;
- made in good faith;
- specific enough for the Association to assess the situation properly.

A person must not wait for a vote or a complaint if the conflict is already known.

6. Methods of Disclosure

A conflict of interest may be disclosed:

- in writing to the Secretary, the President or the Board of Directors;
- at the beginning of a meeting, before discussion of the relevant matter;
- through the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Statement approved by the Board of Directors;
- through a committee chair or a designated ethics/governance person.

Wherever possible, a disclosure should be made in writing.

7. Recusal and Non-Participation

A Covered Person with a conflict of interest must:

- not take part in the discussion;
- not influence the discussion;
- not make or second motions;
- not vote;
- not take part in the decision;
- leave the meeting or refrain from participating in the relevant part of the discussion, if required.

Where necessary, the person may provide factual information before recusing.

8. Determining Whether a Conflict Exists

Where there is doubt, the matter is considered by the disinterested members of the relevant body.

The determination takes into account:

- the nature of the relationship;
- the extent of the benefit;
- the effect on independence;
- the reputational risk;
- the perception of third parties.

9. Procedures for Managing a Conflict

The Association may:

- determine that no conflict exists;
- require recusal;
- restrict participation;
- appoint another participant;
- increase oversight;
- postpone the decision;
- restrict access to information;
- take other measures.

10. Interested Transactions

A transaction may be approved only if:

- the conflict has been disclosed;
- the decision is made by disinterested persons;
- the transaction is fair;
- it is in the best interests of the Association.

11. Compensation Decisions

A person does not take part in decisions on his or her own compensation, expense reimbursement or other financial benefit.

12. Membership, Award and Other Evaluation Decisions

All conflicts in evaluating applications, nominations and participants must be disclosed before the vote. Where a conflict exists, the person is excluded from the review of and vote on the relevant matter.

The recusal procedure for membership application reviews, including the list of situations treated as a conflict, is set out in the Membership Review Policy. The recusal procedure for award evaluations is set out in the Awards and Recognition Policy.

13. Annual Disclosure

Each director and officer of the Association signs the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Statement:

- upon election or appointment, before taking part in the first vote;
- annually, no later than January 31 of each year;
- within 5 business days after any change in the circumstances stated in a previously submitted Statement.

Committee members, judges and evaluators sign the Statement at the request of the Board of Directors. Signed Statements are kept by the Secretary in accordance with the Records Retention Policy.

14. Confidentiality

All information about conflicts is handled confidentially.

15. Documentation

The minutes record:

- who disclosed the conflict;
- the nature of the conflict;
- the recusal;
- the decision.

16. Violations

Violations may result in:

- a warning;
- restriction;
- exclusion from the relevant process;
- removal from a role;
- termination of membership.

17. Relationship to Other Documents

This Policy applies together with:

- the Bylaws (Article 12, "Conflict of Interest");
- the Code of Ethics;
- the Professional Standards;
- the Governance Policy;
- the Membership Review Policy;
- the Board Member Agreement;
- the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Statement.

In the event of a conflict, the Bylaws prevail.

18. Administration

Compliance with this Policy is overseen by the Board of Directors; the Secretary keeps the record of Disclosure Statements.

19. Amendments

Amendments to this Policy are made by the Board of Directors.

20. Official Language

The official version of this Policy is maintained in English. Any translation is provided for convenience only. In the event of any discrepancy, the English version prevails.